

Nirmaan Hyderabad

Breaking Away

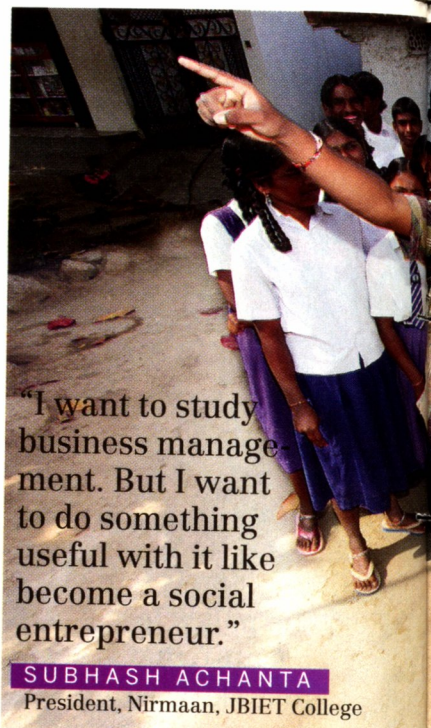
For the enterprising ones at an engineering college, the experience of reaching out to the disadvantaged dawned later in life, quite often as corporate social responsibility. But one can't say that of Subhash Chandra Achanta, 20, who is part of Nirmaan, an initiative for a poverty-free, knowledge-driven society. As president of the Nirmaan chapter at the JBIET College, Hyderabad, he is involved in providing quality education to impoverished youngsters. From providing training in professional, entrepreneurial and vocational skills to rehabilitating the handicapped, it's all in a weekend's work for this group of under-25 students that has evolved since the first such group was spawned at BITS, Pilani, Rajasthan, in 2005 by the then third year student Rakesh Anugula. The activists concede the

greatest challenge before them is scaling up the projects, running a sustainable organisation and inspiring its 400 members to continue with it for life. In all, the four student chapters have adopted 14 government schools across the country, including four in Hyderabad. In a parallel Gyanbodh campaign, Nirmaan runs evening schools at four locations in the country providing education support to around 300 less privileged children. "We plan to spread our mission to more places across the country. While youth is known for its passion and energy, we want older people to come forward as well," says Mayur Patnala, 25, general secretary of the central committee. Having grown from a small group of 10 to 400 in over four years, it should be mission possible.

by Amarnath K. Menon

DREAM

To train impoverished youngsters on weekend breaks



"I want to study business management. But I want to do something useful with it like become a social entrepreneur."

SUBHASH ACHANTA

President, Nirmaan, JBIET College

Hockey Players Bangalore

Hoping for a Goal

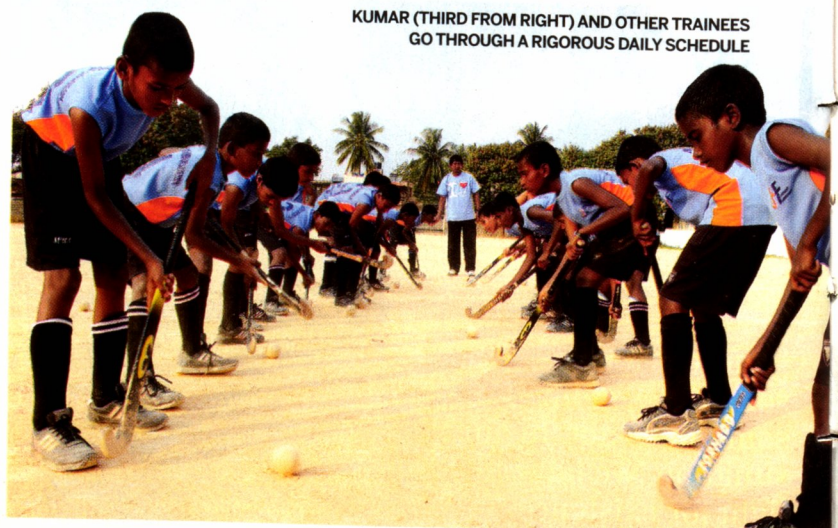
Jaikiran Kumar, 15, had never held a hockey stick in his life. Abandoned at five, his life would have been condemned to aimlessness. But for Christmas day in 2008 when Jude Felix, former national team captain, visited the St Mary's Orphanage in Bangalore. "I went there to give a donation but God gave me an opportunity to train these children into hockey players," says Felix, who was

SANJAY RAMACHANDRAN

DREAM

To play for India and help the national team regain its lost glory

KUMAR (THIRD FROM RIGHT) AND OTHER TRAINEES GO THROUGH A RIGOROUS DAILY SCHEDULE



"These great men take time to train us to be good players. One day we hope to repay by playing for the country."

JAIKIRAN KUMAR
Trainee